

D373

Marketing in the Digital Era

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A meal-kit company divides the market by lifestyle and household size, chooses busy dual-income parents as its focus, and then crafts the message 'dinner on the table in 15 minutes.' The company was founded in Portland and uses recyclable boxes. Crafting that message is which part of STP?

- A. Segmentation
- B. Promotion, one of the 4Ps
- C. Targeting
- D. Positioning

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An online pet-supply store's average customer spends \$60 per order, orders 4 times a year and stays 3 years. Gross margin is 25%. The store's mascot is a golden retriever, and it ships from Ohio. What is customer lifetime value on a margin basis?

- A. \$60
- B. \$720
- C. \$240
- D. \$180

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A subscription app has a CLV of \$240 and wants the common 3:1 CLV-to-acquisition-cost ratio. What is the most it should spend to acquire a customer?

- A. \$720
- B. \$240
- C. \$0; any acquisition spend lowers value
- D. \$80

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A campaign's ads were shown 200,000 times, drew 3,000 clicks and produced 90 purchases. The ads featured a well-known influencer and ran for 10 days. What is the click-through rate?

- A. 3.0%
- B. 66.7
- C. 1.5%
- D. 0.045%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A landing page got 5,000 visitors and has a 2.4% conversion rate. How many conversions did it produce?

- A. 120
- B. About 2,083
- C. 4,880
- D. 12

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A furniture brand spent \$8,000 on social ads that generated \$36,000 in attributed revenue. Its products carry a 40% gross margin, and its showroom is in Atlanta. What is the return on ad spend?

- A. 1.8
- B. 4.5 (\$4.50 per \$1)
- C. About 0.22
- D. 3.5

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A brand targets a ROAS of 5 and expects a campaign to bring in \$60,000 in revenue. What is the maximum ad spend?

- A. \$12,000
- B. \$10,000
- C. \$300,000
- D. \$3,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A skincare brand's product is praised in a popular beauty blogger's unpaid review, and customers share it widely on social media. The brand also runs its own website and pays for search ads. The brand's CEO has a chemistry PhD. Which type of media is the blogger's review?

- A. Owned media
- B. Paid media, because influencers are always paid
- C. Earned media
- D. Paid media

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of owned media?

- A. Any content that mentions the brand online.
- B. The company's email newsletter to its subscribers.
- C. A news article about the company.
- D. A sponsored Instagram post.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A smart-ring maker sees sales rising fast, new competitors entering and profits starting to climb. It sponsors a marathon and recently changed its logo. Which life-cycle stage is it in, and what strategy fits?

- A. Growth: expand distribution and differentiate with new features.
- B. Introduction: build basic awareness.
- C. Decline: harvest and cut spending.
- D. Maturity: defend share with price cuts.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An online outdoor-gear retailer with 2 million email subscribers wants to send a reminder to anyone who leaves items in their cart, one hour later, with no manual work. The retailer's founder is a former park ranger. Which tool fits?

- A. Buying display ads
- B. A monthly newsletter sent to all subscribers
- C. A marketing automation workflow with a behavior-triggered email
- D. AI that needs no rules or data, since it always knows the best message

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A streaming company wants to personalize recommendations as third-party cookies are phased out. It has 8 million subscribers and a new logo. Which data strategy fits best?

- A. Rely on the new logo to build loyalty.
- B. Use first-party data such as viewing history and stated preferences, collected with clear consent and notice.
- C. Collect all possible data without notice, since users accepted the terms.
- D. Buy third-party cookie-based audience lists.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A meal-kit company divides the market by lifestyle and household size, chooses busy dual-income parents as its focus, and then crafts the message 'dinner on the table in 15 minutes.' ~~The company was founded in Portland and uses recyclable boxes.~~ Crafting that message is which part of STP?

Target word: STP step **Decides:** The message about how the brand should be seen.

A	Inverted operation	The first step, dividing the market.
B	Adjacent category	Promotion delivers the message; positioning defines it.
C	Confusion set	Choosing the segment, which came before the message.
D	Correct	Defines the brand's place in the target's mind.

2. Answer D Concept 2

An online pet-supply store's average customer spends \$60 per order, orders 4 times a year and stays 3 years. Gross margin is 25%. ~~The store's mascot is a golden retriever, and it ships from Ohio.~~ What is customer lifetime value on a margin basis?

Target word: CLV **Decides:** $\$60 \times 4 \times 3 \times 25\%$.

A	Confusion set	One year of margin, not lifetime.
B	Dropped element	Revenue; leaves out margin.
C	Wrong stem number	One year of revenue.
D	Correct	$\$720$ lifetime revenue $\times 25\%$.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

A subscription app has a CLV of \$240 and wants the common 3:1 CLV-to-acquisition-cost ratio. What is the most it should spend to acquire a customer?

Target word: solve for CAC **Decides:** $CAC = CLV \div 3$.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 3.
B	Wrong stem number	The CLV itself.
C	Absolute language	Spending below CLV creates value.
D	Correct	$\$240 \div 3$.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A campaign's ads were shown 200,000 times, drew 3,000 clicks and produced 90 purchases. ~~The ads featured a well-known influencer and ran for 10 days.~~ What is the click-through rate?

Target word: CTR **Decides:** $\text{Clicks} \div \text{impressions}$.

A	Confusion set	Conversion rate ($90 \div 3,000$).
B	Inverted operation	$\text{Impressions} \div \text{clicks}$.
C	Correct	$3,000 \div 200,000$.
D	Adjacent category	Purchases per impression.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A landing page got 5,000 visitors and has a 2.4% conversion rate. How many conversions did it produce?

Target word: solve for conversions **Decides:** Visitors $\times$ rate.

A	Correct	$5,000 \times 0.024$.
B	Inverted operation	Divides by 2.4.
C	Adjacent category	Visitors who did not convert.
D	Wrong stem number	Reads 2.4% as 0.24%.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A furniture brand spent \$8,000 on social ads that generated \$36,000 in attributed revenue. ~~Its products carry a 40% gross margin, and its showroom is in Atlanta.~~ What is the return on ad spend?

Target word: ROAS **Decides:** Revenue $\div$ spend.

A	Camouflage	Applies the 40% margin, which standard ROAS does not use.
B	Correct	$\$36,000 \div \$8,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Spend $\div$ revenue.
D	Confusion set	Subtracts spend first, an ROI-style figure.

7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A brand targets a ROAS of 5 and expects a campaign to bring in \$60,000 in revenue. What is the maximum ad spend?

Target word: solve for spend **Decides:** Spend = revenue $\div$ ROAS.

A	Correct	$\$60,000 \div 5$.
B	Confusion set	Treats 5 as an ROI target (revenue $\div$ 6).
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 5.
D	Wrong stem number	Reads 5 as 5% of revenue.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A skincare brand's product is praised in a popular beauty blogger's unpaid review, and customers share it widely on social media. The brand also runs its own website and pays for search ads. ~~The brand's CEO has a chemistry PhD.~~ Which type of media is the blogger's review?

Target word: media type **Decides:** Unpaid coverage by a third party.

A	Adjacent category	The brand's website is owned; the blog is not.
B	Absolute language	The stem says the review was unpaid.
C	Correct	Exposure the brand did not buy or control.
D	Confusion set	The search ads are paid; the review was unpaid.

9. Answer B Concept 5 · transfer

Which is an example of owned media?

Target word: pick owned **Decides:** A channel the brand controls.

A	Absolute language	Most mentions are earned, not owned.
B	Correct	The brand controls the channel and content.
C	Adjacent category	Earned media.
D	Confusion set	Paid media.

10. Answer A Concept 6

A smart-ring maker sees sales rising fast, new competitors entering and profits starting to climb. ~~It sponsors a marathon and recently changed its logo.~~ Which life-cycle stage is it in, and what strategy fits?

Target word: stage and strategy **Decides:** Rapid sales growth, entrants arriving, profits rising.

A	Correct	Build share while the market expands.
B	Confusion set	Introduction has slow sales and few rivals.
C	Inverted operation	Sales are rising, not falling.
D	Adjacent category	Maturity has flat sales, not rapid growth.

11. Answer C Concept 7

An online outdoor-gear retailer ~~with 2 million email subscribers~~ wants to send a reminder to anyone who leaves items in their cart, one hour later, with no manual work. ~~The retailer's founder is a former park ranger.~~ Which tool fits?

Target word: tool **Decides:** A message triggered by a customer action after a set delay.

A	Confusion set	Paid reach, not an automated reminder.
B	Adjacent category	Batch, not triggered by cart behavior.
C	Correct	Automation sends event-based messages on rules.
D	Absolute language	AI tools still need data, goals and oversight.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A streaming company wants to personalize recommendations as third-party cookies are phased out. ~~It has 8 million subscribers and a new logo.~~ Which data strategy fits best?

Target word: data strategy **Decides:** Third-party cookies are going away; consent matters.

A	Camouflage	Branding does not personalize anything.
B	Correct	Durable, permissioned data the company owns.
C	Absolute language	Privacy laws require notice and limits.
D	Inverted operation	Relies on the source being phased out.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Segmentation, targeting, positioning	Segment the market, target the chosen segment, then position the offer with a clear message in that segment's mind.	Calling the message step segmentation or targeting.	Three steps described in order; which one is the message?
2	Customer lifetime value	CLV (margin basis) = average order × orders per year × years retained × gross margin; compare with acquisition cost.	Using revenue instead of margin, or one year only.	Order size, frequency, tenure and margin.
3	Funnel metrics	Click-through rate = clicks ÷ impressions; conversion rate = conversions ÷ clicks (or visitors).	Using the wrong denominator.	Impressions, clicks and purchases in one stem.
4	Return on ad spend	ROAS = attributed revenue ÷ ad spend.	Subtracting spend first (ROI) or applying margin.	Ad spend and attributed revenue.
5	Paid, owned and earned media	Paid = bought placements; owned = channels the brand controls; earned = unpaid coverage and sharing by others.	Calling influencer or press mentions paid by default.	Who controls or paid for the exposure.
6	Product life cycle	Introduction builds awareness; growth brings rising sales, entrants and profits; maturity defends share; decline harvests or exits.	Mistaking growth for maturity when competitors arrive.	Sales trend, competitor entry and profit direction.
7	Marketing automation	Automation sends behavior-triggered messages, such as cart reminders, through rules or workflows without manual effort.	Confusing it with batch newsletters or paid ads.	A message tied to a customer action and a time delay.
8	First-party data and consent	As third-party cookies fade, use first-party data collected with clear consent and privacy notice.	Buying third-party lists or collecting without notice.	Personalization plans under changing privacy rules.

Course scope (public description): Marketing in the Digital Era examines the marketing skills needed to be an effective marketer in the 21st century. This course provides a company and consumer perspective to learn how consumer value is created while achieving organizational goals. Learners will gain knowledge in the core areas of marketing, including branding and products, consumers, communications, and technology. This course introduces learners to strategic marketing tools used to develop effective strategies for a relevant target market. Marketing in the Digital Era teaches learners about emerging topics, such as marketing automation, artificial intelligence, and data-driven communications, as well as skills needed to continue evolving as a successful marketing professional in the dynamic, ever-changing marketing environment.